

Table d'Adrian

N° 04 · RECIPE BOOK · 16 RECIPES · CÔTE D'AZUR & MONACO

Dinner Party *Playbook*

A first bite, a fish, a braise, and a custard. Written for guests.

RECIPES BY ADRIAN STEFAN, TABLE D'ADRIAN

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WELCOME

Dinner Party Playbook

A first bite, a fish, a braise, and a custard. Written for guests.

This book gathers 16 recipes from Adrian Stefan's kitchen library, grouped the way a meal runs: A first bite, Starters, The fish, The braise, On the side and The custard. They are reproduced as written in the library, with the serving size, timings, ingredients, method and a note on plating for each dish.

How to use this book

- Read a recipe through once before you shop. Quantities are in grams and millilitres, oven temperatures in °C.
- Each recipe lists its allergens. Check them against your guests.
- The "Variations & swaps" notes show how a dish can change with the season or the table.

> Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.

About the chef

Adrian Stefan is a private chef on the Côte d'Azur and in Monaco, based in Antibes, cooking for villas, yachts and private dinners. Swiss-trained (EHL), 10+ years, Nutrition certificate, Stanford.

Book a private dinner

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CHAPTER ONE · 3 RECIPES

A first bite

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A FIRST BITE

Gougères au Comté, Black Pepper

Serves 8 · Prep 20 min · Cook 30 min

"Burgundy's cheese puffs — crackly outside, molten-savory inside; pipe and freeze trays of them for instant apéros all season."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 8, ~40 PIECES)

- Water — 125 ml
- Whole milk — 125 ml
- Unsalted butter — 100 g
- Fine salt — 4 g
- Plain flour — 150 g
- Eggs — 4 (about 220 g)
- Comté, finely grated — 150 g
- Black pepper, coarse — 2 g
- Nutmeg — 0.5 g
- Extra Comté for tops — 30 g

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 190 °C fan. Bring water, milk, butter and salt to a full boil.
2. Off heat, add flour all at once; beat hard. Return to medium heat and dry the panade 2 min until it films the pan.
3. Transfer to a bowl; cool 3 min. Beat in eggs one at a time until the paste falls from the spatula in a slow V.
4. Beat in Comté, pepper and nutmeg.
5. Pipe 3.5 cm domes onto lined trays; top each with a pinch of extra Comté.
6. Bake 25–30 min without opening the door, until deep golden and hollow-sounding.
7. Serve warm; re-crisp day-old ones at 160 °C for 4 min.

PLATING & SERVICE

Pile in a warm napkin-lined bowl with champagne — they vanish in minutes.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Swap Comté for Gruyère or aged Mimolette. Freeze piped raw; bake from frozen adding 5 min.

Allergens: gluten, dairy, eggs

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A FIRST BITE

Rillettes de Saumon aux Deux Façons

Serves 8 · Prep 25 min · Cook 10 min

"Poached fresh salmon folded with smoked salmon and lemony butter — two textures in one pot, ready in 30 minutes for apéro hour."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 8)

- Fresh salmon fillet, skinless — 400 g
- Smoked salmon, chopped — 150 g
- Unsalted butter, soft — 80 g
- Crème fraîche — 60 g
- Lemon zest — 4 g
- Lemon juice — 20 ml
- Chives, sliced — 15 g
- Dill, chopped — 8 g
- Espelette pepper — 1 g
- Fine salt — 4 g
- Court-bouillon: water 1 L, white wine 100 ml, bay 1, peppercorns 3 g

METHOD

1. Bring court-bouillon to 80 °C; slide in the fresh salmon and poach 8–10 min to a core of 50 °C. Drain and cool.
2. Beat butter with crème fraîche, lemon zest, juice, Espelette and salt.
3. Flake the poached salmon coarsely into the butter mixture — keep visible flakes.
4. Fold in smoked salmon, chives and dill; do not overwork.
5. Pack into a jar or terrine, smooth the top, chill 2 h minimum.
6. Pull from the fridge 20 min before serving.

PLATING & SERVICE

Serve in the jar with toasted baguette, radishes and lemon; or quenelle onto blinis for canapés.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Dairy-free: use whipped olive oil emulsion instead of butter/crème fraîche. Swap salmon for hot-smoked trout for a stronger cure note.

Allergens: fish, dairy

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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A FIRST BITE

Escargots de Bourgogne, Hazelnut Garlic Butter

Serves 4 · Prep 20 min · Cook 12 min

"Classic snail butter sharpened with toasted hazelnut and a hit of pastis — the bubbling dish arrives at the table still hissing."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 4)

- Cooked Burgundy snails (canned, drained) — 24 (about 250 g)
- Unsalted butter, soft — 200 g
- Garlic, very finely minced — 25 g
- Flat-leaf parsley, chopped — 30 g
- Shallot, minced — 30 g
- Toasted hazelnuts, finely chopped — 30 g
- Pastis — 10 ml
- Lemon juice — 10 ml
- Fine salt — 5 g
- Black pepper — 1.5 g
- Baguette — 1 (250 g)

METHOD

1. Beat butter with garlic, parsley, shallot, hazelnuts, pastis, lemon, salt and pepper. Chill 20 min so it pipes cleanly.
2. Rinse snails, pat dry, and season lightly.
3. Place one snail in each well of two escargot dishes (or shells); pipe butter generously over each, sealing the well.
4. Rest 15 min in the fridge so the butter anchors.
5. Bake at 200 °C for 8–10 min until the butter foams and just starts to brown at the edges.
6. Warm baguette alongside for the last 5 min.

PLATING & SERVICE

Straight from oven to table on a folded napkin; serve with tongs, picks and plenty of bread for the butter.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Nut-free: omit hazelnuts, add 10 g fine breadcrumbs for texture. No snails aboard? The same butter over roasted king oyster mushrooms is superb.

Allergens: dairy, nuts, gluten

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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CHAPTER TWO · 3 RECIPES

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STARTERS

Coquilles Saint-Jacques Gratinées, Vermouth Cream

Serves 4 · Prep 25 min · Cook 20 min

"Scallops baked in their shells under a vermouth velouté and golden crumb — retro in the best way, and pure theatre at the table."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 4)

- King scallops, roe off — 12 (about 360 g)
- Scallop shells (or small gratin dishes) — 4
- Button mushrooms, sliced — 150 g
- Shallots, minced — 60 g
- Unsalted butter — 70 g
- Dry vermouth — 80 ml
- Fish stock — 150 ml
- Double cream — 150 ml
- Plain flour — 15 g
- Fine breadcrumbs — 40 g
- Gruyère, grated — 40 g
- Lemon juice — 10 ml
- Fine salt — 5 g
- White pepper — 1 g

METHOD

1. Sear scallops hard in 20 g butter, 45 sec per side; remove (they stay rare inside). Quarter them.
2. In the same pan, sweat shallots and mushrooms in 20 g butter, 5 min.
3. Dust with flour, cook 1 min; add vermouth and stock, whisking, then cream. Simmer 4 min to a coating sauce; season with salt, pepper, lemon.
4. Fold scallops into the sauce off the heat.
5. Fill shells; top with breadcrumbs mixed with Gruyère and remaining 30 g melted butter.
6. Gratinate at 220 °C for 8–10 min until bubbling and golden.

PLATING & SERVICE

Shells on a bed of coarse salt to keep them level, lemon wedge alongside.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

GF: thicken with cornflour and use GF crumbs. Normandy style: swap vermouth for dry cider and add 20 g apple brunoise.

Allergens: shellfish, dairy, gluten, sulphites

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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STARTERS

Poireaux Vinaigrette, Hazelnut & Egg Mimosa

Serves 4 · Prep 15 min · Cook 25 min

"Bistro minimalism — leeks poached to a melt, marinated warm so they drink the vinaigrette, showered with sieved egg."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 4)

- Slim leeks, trimmed — 8 (about 800 g)
- Dijon mustard — 20 g
- Red wine vinegar — 30 ml
- Extra virgin olive oil — 90 ml
- Shallot, minced — 30 g
- Capers, chopped — 15 g
- Eggs — 2
- Toasted hazelnuts, crushed — 30 g
- Chervil or parsley — 6 g
- Fine salt — 5 g
- Black pepper — 1 g

METHOD

1. Tie leeks in two bundles; simmer in well-salted water 18–22 min until a knife slides through with no resistance.
2. Drain cut-side down on a rack 10 min, pressing gently — waterlogged leeks ruin the dish.
3. Whisk mustard, vinegar and salt; stream in oil; add shallot and capers.
4. Halve leeks lengthwise while warm and lay in a dish; spoon over two-thirds of the vinaigrette. Marinate 30 min minimum.
5. Boil eggs 10 min, cool, peel; sieve yolks and whites separately.
6. Serve leeks at room temperature with remaining vinaigrette, egg mimosa, hazelnuts and chervil.

PLATING & SERVICE

Line leeks like sleepers on a flat plate, stripe the mimosa across the centre, nuts and herbs over.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Vegan: omit egg, double the hazelnuts and add crisp shallots. Char the poached leeks on a plancha for a smoky register.

Allergens: eggs, mustard, nuts

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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STARTERS

Soufflé au Comté, Twice-Baked

Serves 6 · Prep 30 min · Cook 40 min

"The service-proof soufflé: bake ahead, then flash in cream to order — it re-rises and arrives bulletproof even in a swell."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Unsalted butter — 60 g (plus 20 g for moulds)
- Plain flour — 60 g
- Whole milk — 350 ml
- Comté, grated — 180 g
- Egg yolks — 4 (80 g)
- Egg whites — 5 (150 g)
- Dijon mustard — 10 g
- Nutmeg — 0.5 g
- Fine salt — 5 g
- White pepper — 1 g
- Double cream — 200 ml
- Fine breadcrumbs — 20 g

METHOD

1. Butter six 150 ml dariole moulds and dust with breadcrumbs. Oven to 170 °C.
2. Make a blond roux with butter and flour, 2 min; whisk in milk gradually and cook to a thick béchamel, 4 min.
3. Off heat, beat in 140 g Comté, yolks, mustard, nutmeg, salt and pepper.
4. Whip whites to soft peaks with a pinch of salt; fold in thirds into the base.
5. Fill moulds to 1 cm below the rim; bake in a bain-marie 20 min until risen and just set.
6. Cool 10 min; unmould onto a tray (they will deflate — that's fine). Chill up to 24 h.
7. To serve: set soufflés in a gratin dish, pour cream around, scatter remaining Comté, bake at 200 °C for 12–14 min until re-puffed and glazed.

PLATING & SERVICE

Serve in the gratin dish or plated with the Comté cream spooned over and a bitter-leaf salad.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

GF: swap flour for rice flour and breadcrumbs for polenta. Add 50 g chopped ham between bakes for a non-vegetarian version.

Allergens: gluten, dairy, eggs, mustard

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.

THE FISH

Sole Meunière, Brown Butter & Lemon

Serves 2 · Prep 15 min · Cook 12 min

"Whole Dover sole, floured and basted in foaming beurre noisette — the dish that proves restraint is the highest technique."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 2)

- Dover sole, skinned both sides, head on — 2 (400–500 g each)
- Plain flour — 40 g
- Whole milk — 50 ml
- Clarified butter — 40 g
- Unsalted butter, diced — 100 g
- Lemon — 1 (half juiced, ~20 ml; half in wedges)
- Capers, rinsed — 20 g
- Flat-leaf parsley, chopped — 10 g
- Fine salt — 5 g
- White pepper — 1 g

METHOD

1. Trim fins with scissors; pat the soles very dry, season both sides.
2. Dip in milk, then flour; shake off every excess grain — a veil, not a coat.
3. Heat clarified butter in a pan large enough for the fish over medium-high heat.
4. Lay in the sole presentation-side down; cook 4–5 min without moving until deep golden.
5. Turn carefully with a fish slice; add the diced butter and cook 3–4 min, basting constantly as it goes noisette (hazelnut-brown, smelling toasty).
6. Check doneness at the thickest point behind the head — flesh should lift from the bone; core 52–54 °C.
7. Transfer to hot plates. Off heat, add lemon juice, capers and parsley to the butter; spoon over immediately.

PLATING & SERVICE

Whole on the plate, sauce spooned along the backbone, lemon wedge and nothing else — bone it tableside for guests.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

GF: dust with rice flour. Same method suits plaice or small turbot; add 30 g toasted almonds for amandine.

Allergens: fish, dairy, gluten

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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THE FISH

Saumon à l'Oseille, Sorrel Cream

Serves 4 · Prep 15 min · Cook 15 min

"Barely-cooked salmon escalopes under a sharp sorrel cream — the nouvelle-cuisine idea that acidity, not butter, should carry rich fish."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 4)

- Salmon fillet, skinless, cut into 1.5 cm escalopes — 700 g
- Sorrel leaves, stemmed — 100 g
- Shallots, minced — 60 g
- Dry white wine — 100 ml
- Dry vermouth — 40 ml
- Fish stock — 150 ml
- Double cream — 250 ml
- Unsalted butter — 20 g
- Lemon juice — 10 ml
- Fine salt — 6 g
- White pepper — 1 g

METHOD

1. Reduce shallots, wine and vermouth to 30 ml; add stock, reduce by half.
2. Add cream; simmer to light coating consistency, about 5 min.
3. Chiffonade the sorrel; stir into the sauce off the heat — it will olive instantly and turn the sauce tangy. Season with salt, pepper, lemon.
4. Season escalopes. Heat a dry non-stick pan until hot; brush fish with butter.
5. Cook escalopes 45–60 sec per side only — the centre must stay coral (48 °C).
6. Pool sauce on hot plates, lay salmon on top so it finishes in the sauce's heat.

PLATING & SERVICE

Sauce first, fish on top, a few raw sorrel ribbons; steamed cucumber or ratte potatoes beside.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

No sorrel? Use spinach plus 25 ml extra lemon. Trout or arctic char escalopes respond identically.

Allergens: fish, dairy, sulphites

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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CHAPTER FOUR · 3 RECIPES

The braise

Coq au Vin de Bourgogne 16

Bœuf Bourguignon à l'Ancienne 18

Navarin d'Agneau Printanier 19

Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.

THE BRAISE

Coq au Vin de Bourgogne

Serves 6 · Prep 40 min · Cook 120 min

"Chicken legs braised in reduced red wine with the holy trinity of lardons, pearl onions and mushrooms — marinate overnight and the sauce turns profound."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Chicken legs, whole (or 1 jointed large bird) — 6 (about 1.8 kg)
- Red Burgundy — 750 ml
- Brown chicken stock — 400 ml
- Cognac — 40 ml
- Smoked bacon lardons — 180 g
- Pearl onions, peeled — 250 g
- Button mushrooms — 300 g
- Carrot, chunks — 150 g
- Onion, chunks — 150 g
- Garlic — 15 g
- Tomato paste — 25 g
- Plain flour — 25 g
- Unsalted butter — 50 g
- Thyme — 5 sprigs; bay 2
- Fine salt — 12 g; black pepper 2 g
- Sugar — 5 g

METHOD

1. Marinate chicken overnight in wine with carrot, onion, garlic, thyme and bay.
2. Drain (keep everything); pat chicken very dry; season. Boil the wine, skimming, 5 min.

Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.

CONTINUED

Coq au Vin de Bourgogne

METHOD, CONTINUED

3 Render lardons in a cocotte; remove. Brown chicken hard in the fat, in batches; remove.

4 Brown marinade vegetables 5 min; add tomato paste and flour, cook 2 min.

5 Add Cognac, flambé; add wine and stock. Return chicken and lardons; braise, lid on, at 150 °C oven for 75–90 min until the meat waves on the bone.

6 Meanwhile glaze pearl onions with 25 g butter, sugar and 100 ml water, 12 min; sauté mushrooms in remaining butter until golden.

7 Lift chicken; strain and reduce sauce to coating consistency; season.

8 Reunite chicken, sauce, onions, mushrooms and lardons; simmer 5 min.

PLATING & SERVICE

Serve from the cocotte with pommes purée or buttered tagliatelle; parsley over.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

GF: thicken with 15 g cornflour at the end instead of flour. Alsace variation: use Riesling and finish with cream (coq au Riesling).

Allergens: gluten, dairy, sulphites, celery

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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THE BRAISE

Bœuf Bourguignon à l'Ancienne

Serves 6 · Prep 40 min · Cook 210 min

"Chuck and shin in reduced Burgundy with the classic garnish — built a day ahead, because bourguignon on day two is a different, better dish."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Beef chuck, 5 cm cubes — 1 kg
- Beef shin, 5 cm cubes — 500 g
- Red Burgundy — 750 ml
- Brown veal or beef stock — 500 ml
- Smoked bacon lardons — 200 g
- Carrot, chunks — 200 g
- Onion, chunks — 200 g
- Garlic — 15 g
- Tomato paste — 30 g
- Plain flour — 30 g
- Pearl onions — 250 g
- Button mushrooms — 300 g
- Unsalted butter — 50 g
- Thyme — 5 sprigs; bay 2
- Fine salt — 14 g; black pepper 2 g; sugar 5 g

METHOD

1. Marinate beef in wine with carrot, onion, garlic and herbs overnight, chilled.
2. Drain; dry the meat obsessively. Boil the wine 5 min, skimming.
3. Render lardons in a cocotte; remove. Brown beef in batches, hard, in the fat; remove.
4. Brown the vegetables 5 min; add tomato paste and flour, cook 2 min.
5. Return beef; add wine and stock to barely cover. Braise, lid ajar, at 150 °C for 2.5–3 h until a spoon cuts the meat.
6. Glaze pearl onions with 25 g butter, sugar, 100 ml water, 12 min; sauté mushrooms golden in the rest.
7. Lift meat; strain and reduce sauce until it naps a spoon; season.
8. Reunite everything with the lardons; simmer 5 min (better: cool overnight, reheat gently).

PLATING & SERVICE

Deep plates over pommes purée; the sauce should ribbon, not flood.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

GF: use cornflour at the end. Cheek-only version (all beef cheek, 3.5 h) is even silkier.

Allergens: gluten, sulphites, celery

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THE BRAISE

Navarin d'Agneau Printanier

Serves 6 · Prep 35 min · Cook 120 min

"Spring lamb stew with baby vegetables added in waves so each lands perfectly cooked — the season's greenest braise."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Lamb shoulder, 5 cm cubes — 1.4 kg
- Olive oil — 40 ml
- Plain flour — 25 g
- Tomato paste — 30 g
- Garlic — 12 g
- Dry white wine — 200 ml
- Brown lamb or chicken stock — 900 ml
- Tomatoes, chopped — 200 g
- Thyme — 4 sprigs; bay 1; rosemary 1 sprig
- Baby carrots — 300 g
- Baby turnips, halved — 250 g
- Small new potatoes — 400 g
- Peas — 150 g
- Green beans, cut — 150 g
- Fine salt — 13 g; black pepper 2 g; sugar 4 g

METHOD

1. Season lamb; brown hard in oil in batches; return all to the pot.
2. Sprinkle with flour and sugar; roast in the pot at 200 °C, 5 min (singeing — toasts the flour).

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CONTINUED

Navarin d'Agneau Printanier

METHOD, CONTINUED

3 Add tomato paste and garlic, 2 min on the hob; add wine, scraping; add stock, tomatoes and herbs.

4 Braise, lid ajar, at 160 °C for 60 min.

5 Add carrots, turnips and potatoes; braise 30 min more.

6 Blanch beans and peas 2 min in salted water; ice.

7 When lamb is spoon-tender, skim fat, season the sauce, fold in the green vegetables and warm 3 min.

PLATING & SERVICE

Rustic bowls, vegetables displayed on top, chopped parsley if you like — no starch needed, the potatoes are in.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

GF: cornflour finish instead of the flour singe. Autumn navarin: swap green veg for celeriac, chestnuts and grapes.

Allergens: gluten, celery, sulphites

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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CHAPTER FIVE · 2 RECIPES

On the side

Pommes Anna au Beurre Clarifié 22

Carottes Vichy Glacées 23

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ON THE SIDE

Pommes Anna au Beurre Clarifié

Serves 6 · Prep 25 min · Cook 60 min

"Concentric potato petals pressed into a butter-crisped cake — inverted at the table to a collective intake of breath."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Waxy potatoes, even cylinders — 1.2 kg
- Clarified butter, melted — 150 g
- Fine salt — 10 g
- White pepper — 1 g
- Thyme leaves — 2 g

METHOD

1. Oven to 200 °C. Peel potatoes; trim into even cylinders; slice 2 mm on a mandoline. Do not rinse.
2. Toss slices with 100 g clarified butter, salt, pepper and thyme.
3. Brush a 20 cm ovenproof frying pan (or copper pommes Anna mould) with butter; start a tight rosette of overlapping slices in the centre, spiralling out.
4. Layer the rest in neat overlapping circles, pressing each layer down; pour remaining butter over.
5. Start on the hob, medium heat, 8 min — the base must begin frying.
6. Cover with foil; bake 30 min. Uncover; bake 20 min more.
7. Rest 5 min; pour off excess butter, run a palette knife around, invert boldly onto a board.
8. The crown should be mahogany and lacquered; salt lightly.

PLATING & SERVICE

Cut into wedges like a cake beside roast chicken or beef; the interior stays supple, the outside shatters.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Slip garlic slivers and rosemary between layers. Duck-fat version for magret nights is devastating.

Allergens: dairy

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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ON THE SIDE

Carottes Vichy Glacées

Serves 4 · Prep 10 min · Cook 20 min

"Carrots glazed 'à blanc' in butter, sugar and their own liquor until mirror-shiny — the technique that teaches glazing for every vegetable after."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 4)

- Carrots, peeled, 5 mm rounds (or turned barrels) — 600 g
- Unsalted butter — 50 g
- Caster sugar — 12 g
- Fine salt — 4 g
- Water (sparkling, in true Vichy spirit) — to barely cover (~300 ml)
- Lemon juice — 8 ml
- Flat-leaf parsley, chopped — 8 g
- Black pepper — 0.5 g

METHOD

1. Lay carrots in a single crowded layer in a wide sauté pan.
2. Add butter, sugar, salt and water to barely cover; press on a paper cartouche with a small hole.
3. Simmer briskly 12–15 min; the water evaporates as the carrots cook.
4. When the liquid is nearly gone, remove the cartouche and roll the carrots in the forming glaze.
5. Cook 2–3 min more, tossing, until each round is lacquered and tender with slight resistance.
6. Brighten with lemon; season; parsley at the end.

PLATING & SERVICE

Shingled or tumbled beside braises and roasts — each piece should shine individually.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Glaze 'à brun': push 2 min further to caramel for roasted meats. Same method: turnips, pearl onions, radishes. Vegan: olive oil + 5 g extra sugar.

Allergens: dairy

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.



Mood image · Photo: Max Griss / Unsplash

CHAPTER SIX · 3 RECIPES

The custard

Crème Brûlée à la Vanille de Tahiti 25

Crème Caramel de Grand-Mère 26

Îles Flottantes, Crème Anglaise Vanille 27

Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.

THE CUSTARD

Crème Brûlée à la Vanille de Tahiti

Serves 6 · Prep 20 min · Cook 45 min

"A yolk-rich custard baked to the faintest tremble under a glass-thin burnt sugar lid — crack tests are performed tableside, obviously."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Double cream — 600 ml
- Whole milk — 100 ml
- Vanilla pods (Tahitian) — 1.5
- Egg yolks — 8 (160 g)
- Caster sugar — 90 g
- Fine salt — 1 g
- Demerara or caster sugar, for the crust — 60 g

METHOD

1. Split and scrape vanilla into cream and milk; bring to 85 °C; infuse 20 min, pods in.
2. Whisk yolks with 90 g sugar and salt until just combined — don't aerate.
3. Rewarm cream; pour onto yolks, whisking; strain through a fine sieve; rest 10 min and skim the foam.
4. Fill six shallow 150 ml brûlée dishes.
5. Bake in a bain-marie at 120 °C for 35–45 min until set at the edges with a 3 cm tremble at the centre (core 82 °C).
6. Chill uncovered 4 h minimum.
7. To serve: blot any moisture; sprinkle an even 10 g sugar per dish; torch in circles to a dark amber glass. Rest 2 min to harden.

PLATING & SERVICE

On a saucer with a teaspoon — the first tap should sound like ice cracking on a pond.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Infusions: coffee beans (15 g), lavender (2 g, careful), or orange zest. Lighter (technically): half milk, bake 10 min longer.

Allergens: dairy, eggs

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.

THE CUSTARD

Crème Caramel de Grand-Mère

Serves 6 · Prep 20 min · Cook 50 min

"The wobbling, self-saucing classic — whole-egg custard unmoulds itself in a moat of bitter caramel; humbler than brûlée, harder to perfect."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Caster sugar (caramel) — 150 g
- Water — 40 ml
- Whole milk — 750 ml
- Vanilla pod — 1
- Eggs — 4 (220 g)
- Egg yolks — 2 (40 g)
- Caster sugar (custard) — 110 g
- Fine salt — 1 g

METHOD

1. Cook 150 g sugar with the water to a true amber caramel — darker than instinct suggests; it sweetens under custard.
2. Divide caramel instantly between six 150 ml ramekins, tilting to coat the bases.
3. Bring milk with the split vanilla pod to 85 °C; infuse 15 min.
4. Whisk eggs, yolks, 110 g sugar and salt gently; pour on the warm milk; strain; skim.
5. Fill ramekins; bake in a bain-marie at 140 °C for 40–50 min until set with a central tremble (core 82 °C).
6. Chill at least 6 h — overnight lets the caramel liquefy fully.
7. Run a knife around each; invert onto rimmed plates with one decisive shake.

PLATING & SERVICE

Serve solo in its caramel moat — no garnish tradition allows, though a thin langue de chat is forgiven.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Coffee: infuse 20 g crushed beans. Coconut: half milk, half coconut milk (keep dairy tag). The wobble, not the clock, is the doneness test.

Allergens: dairy, eggs

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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THE CUSTARD

Îles Flottantes, Crème Anglaise Vanille

Serves 6 · Prep 30 min · Cook 25 min

"Poached meringue islands adrift on vanilla anglaise under caramel threads — the grandmother dessert that still stops a dining salon."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Crème anglaise: whole milk — 500 ml
- Vanilla pod — 1
- Egg yolks — 6 (120 g)
- Caster sugar — 80 g
- Meringue: egg whites — 6 (180 g)
- Caster sugar — 100 g
- Fine salt — 1 g
- Caramel: caster sugar — 100 g; water 30 ml
- Toasted flaked almonds — 30 g

METHOD

1. Anglaise: infuse split vanilla in milk at 85 °C, 15 min. Whisk yolks with 80 g sugar; temper with the milk; return and stir to 83 °C — nappe stage. Strain; chill over ice.
2. Whip whites with salt to soft peaks; rain in 100 g sugar; whip to glossy, firm-but-supple peaks.
3. Poach: barely simmering water (or milk) at 85 °C — scoop large quenelles, poach 90 sec per side. They swell, then settle.
4. Drain the islands on a cloth; chill 30 min.
5. Caramel: cook sugar and water to amber; cool 1 min until it ribbons off a spoon.
6. Pour anglaise into shallow bowls; float an island on each.
7. Thread caramel over in fast zigzags; scatter almonds. Serve within the hour.

PLATING & SERVICE

Wide chilled bowls, caramel spun at the last minute so it stays crisp against the soft island.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Microwave cheat: cook meringue in ramekins 20 sec at 600 W. Nut-free: praline-free, use candied citrus.

Allergens: dairy, eggs, nuts

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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Table d'Adrian

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